

Camilo Acosta

Inter-American Development Bank
1300 New York Avenue, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20577, USA
Contact: camiloac@iadb.org; cacostam123@gmail.com
URL: <https://sites.google.com/view/cacostam>

Summary

Results-driven economist with extensive experience in international development and academia, specializing in economic research, impact evaluation, and evidence-based decision-making. Currently leading initiatives at the Inter-American Development Bank to strengthen the link between knowledge, operations, and development effectiveness. Ph.D. in Economic Analysis and Policy from the University of Toronto, with expertise in firms, trade, and cities, and a strong publication record in top-tier journals.

Education

- 2014-2020 Ph.D. in Economic Analysis and Policy, Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto, Canada
- 2012-2013 M.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.
- 2008-2012 B.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.

Employment

- 2023- **Inter-American Development Bank**, Washington, DC.
Specialist, Knowledge and Learning Division
Relevant Duties and Responsibilities:
 - Participate in the Development Effectiveness Framework reform group.
 - Developed knowledge indicators for the Impact Framework, the Knowledge Influence Index, and other metrics assessing evidence use in operations.
 - Lead a team building Evidence Gap Maps to support the use of evidence in operations.
 - Support the monitoring of impact evaluations.
 - Study executing units' engagement and commitment to enhancing project effectiveness.
 - Support the Knowledge Advisory Committee.
 - Write the Annual Report on the state of knowledge at the IDB Group.*Key Achievements:*
 - Proposed and implemented two of the new knowledge indicators for the IDB Group Impact Framework.
 - Construction of a Knowledge Influence Index for the IDB.
 - Work together with zie and SPD/SDV in the construction and implementation of the IDB's first Evidence Gap Maps for the Citizen Security and Transportation divisions.
 - Technical Note published studying IDB's project executing units.
 - Member of two multi-departmental teams winning R&D Technical Cooperations being implemented in 2025.
 - Supported the the Amazon's Unit Knowledge Agenda and Brazil's 2024-2027 Country Strategy.
- 2022-2023 **Aalborg University**, Copenhagen, Denmark.
External Research Fellow for the Project RESPOND, BUILD-Department of the Built Environment.
Relevant Duties and Responsibilities:
 - Designed two rounds of a national survey to study firms' management strategies during and after the COVID-19 pandemic in Denmark.
 - Write a research article reporting the survey results.
- 2020-2023 **Universidad EAFIT**, Medellin, Colombia.
Assistant Professor, School of Finance, Economics and Government.
Relevant Duties and Responsibilities:

- Conduct independent research.
- Participate in projects supporting public policy.
- Teach courses and advise theses.
- Participate in the Job Market hiring and Undergraduate Reform committees.

Key Achievements:

- Co-lead three projects providing support to public policy interventions in Colombia: (i) the design of an impact evaluation for a housing improvement program, (ii) the socioeconomic valuation of an urban renewal program, and (iii) the economic analysis of a proposal for a gradual business formalization program.
- Published three peer-reviewed articles in top field Q1 journals and started various other research projects.
- Runner-up, Excellence in Teaching Award.
- Adviser for five undergraduate and five master's degree theses.

Publications

“Quality of Communications Infrastructure, Local Structural Transformation, and Inequality” with Luis Baldomero Quintana. 2024. *Journal of Economic Geography*. [\[LINK\]](#)

“Uncertainty and Immigrant Entrepreneurship: Evidence from Brexit,” with Astrid Marinoni. 2023. *Organization Science* [\[LINK\]](#)

“Access to Formal Financial Markets and Microbusiness Formalization in Colombia,” with Acevedo, A., & Angel, A. 2023. *Revista Coyuntura Económica de Fedesarrollo*. [\[LINK\]](#)

“The Internal Spatial Organization of Firms: Evidence from Denmark,” with Ditte Håkonsson Lyngemark. 2021. *Journal of Urban Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)

“Pobreza, Brechas y Ruralidad en Colombia,” with Parra-Peña, R.I., & Ordoñez, L. 2013. *Revista Coyuntura Económica de Fedesarrollo*. [\[LINK\]](#)

IDB Publications

“Unveiling the IDB’s Project Executing Units: Performance Indicators, Results-Based Management, and Demand for Knowledge” with Cambra, G., Martínez-Carrasco, J., Cerda, M., Kang, M., Villalba, H., & Yepez, C. 2024. *IDB Technical Note TN-02961*. [\[LINK\]](#)

Work in Progress and Working Papers

“Spatial Wage Differentials, Geographic Frictions and the Organization of Labor within Firms,” with Ditte Håkonsson Lyngemark, 2023. *Revise and Resubmit - Regional Science and Urban Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)

“On the Tension Between Due Process Protection and Public Safety: The Case of an Extensive Procedural Reform in Colombia,” with Angela Zorro-Medina and Daniel Mejía, 2023. *Revise and Resubmit - Journal of Law and Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)

“Superstar ZIP Codes,” with Fabian Eckert and Jack Liang, 2024. *Draft available on request*.

“Resilience Strategies of Danish Firms in the Pandemic. A Survey Analysis,” with Nino Javakhishvili-Larsen and Bence János Bøje-Kovács, 2024. *Submitted. Draft available on request*.

“Are Free Trade Agreements being Used? Transaction Level Evidence for Colombia,” with Cindy Leal, 2023. [\[LINK\]](#)

“The Incidence of Land Use Regulations.” Documento de Trabajo CIEF 21-04, 2021. [\[LINK\]](#)

“Birth Rates, Factor Shares and Growth.” with Andrés Alvarez, Camilo Gomez and Hernando Zuleta. Documento CEDE 2019-20. [\[LINK\]](#)

Book Chapters

“Un Enfoque Económico de la Detención Preventiva. Crecimiento de la Población Reclusa y Hacinamiento Carcelario en el Tránsito del Sistema Penal Acusatorio Colombiano (2003-2008).” (with Hernandez, N., & Zorro-Medina, A.) In E. Lozano -Rodríguez (Ed.), *Teoría y Puesta en Práctica del Análisis Económico del Derecho Colombiano* (pp. 251-282) Bogotá: Ediciones Uniandes, 2016.

Referee Service

Journal of Urban Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Real Estate Economics, Journal of Regional Sciences, Scientific Reports, Journal of Economics and Management Strategy, Journal of Housing Economics, IDB Working Paper Series, European Journal of International Management, Desarrollo y Sociedad, Built Environment, Journal of Economic Structures.

Teaching Experience

- 2024-2025 Advanced Microeconomics (Invited Instructor); Graduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020-2023 Advanced Microeconomics, Industrial Organization, Topics in Urban Economics; Graduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020-2023 General Macroeconomics, Industrial Organization; Undergraduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2015-2019 Teaching Assistant, International Trade, Advanced Macroeconomics, Real Estate Economics, Real Estate Investment, Managerial Economics, Model-Based Decision Making; MBA and Undergraduate programs, University of Toronto.

Other Research Experience

- 2016-2019 Research Assistant for Professors Nathaniel Baum-Snow, William Strange, Lu Han, and Mitchell Hoffman. University of Toronto.
- 2013-2014 Research Assistant for Professors Marcela Eslava, John Haltiwanger, Hernando Zuleta, and Hernán Vallejo. Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.

Conferences & Talks

- 2024 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Urban Economic Association Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Southern Economic Association Meetings (Washington, D.C.).
- 2023 University of North Texas, Universidad ICESI (Cali), AREUEA Online Seminar, 4th Urban and Regional Economics Workshop - U Javeriana & RSAI (Bogota), Transitional Entrepreneurship Colloquium (Virtual).
- 2022 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Workshop on Strategy and Structure of Business Groups (CEPR - Milan), Congreso Anual de la Red de Investigadores de Economía (Cali).
- 2021 Banco de la República (Medellín), American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Virtual), ICESI (Cali), Zoning Bylaw Renewal Team (Edmonton).
- 2020 ENSAE - CREST (Paris), Pontificia Universidad Javeriana (Bogota), Universidad EAFIT (Medellin), Online Urban Economics Seminar (organized by Philadelphia FED), Virtual Urban Economic Association Meetings.
- 2019 Canadian Urban Economics Conference (Montreal), 2nd Urban and Regional Economics Workshop - U Javeriana (Bogota), University of Toronto.
- 2018 Canadian Economic Association Meetings (Montreal), Urban Economic Association Meetings (New York), Kraks Fond (Copenhagen).

PROGRAM COMMITTEE

Urban Economics Association Meetings, 2022; The Economics of Informality Conference, Universidad del Rosario, 2022; Latin American and Caribbean Economics Association (LACEA), 2021; 5th RES Symposium of Junior Researchers - Royal Economic Society, 2019.

Honors & Awards

- 2024 AI for Growth (Technical Cooperation), Inter-American Development Bank.
- 2024 Development Effectiveness Intelligence Fund (Technical Cooperation), Inter-American Development Bank.
- 2020-2022 Internal Research Funding, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020 Hartle Award (for outstanding graduate scholarship on a policy-relevant topic), Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.
- 2019-2020 University of Toronto Fellowship (UTF).

2014-2019 PhD Fellowship, Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.
2016-2019 Myron J. Gordon Fellowship. Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.
2017 CRESSE Fellowship in Competition Policy.
2008-2013 “The Best Students”, SAB Miller - Bavaria S.A, Bogotá, Colombia.

Additional Skills

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (advanced), German (intermediate).

Softwares: Stata, GIS, Python, R, PowerBI, $\text{\LaTeX}$